IE

InterviewEra

AI-Powered Mock Interview Platform

Complete Branding & Design Guide

Logo, Favicon, Marketing Assets & Implementation

Domain: interviewera.com
Stack: Next.js + Supabase
Status: 27 users • 49 interviews • ₹1600 revenue

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1. Reality Check: Claude vs Design Tools

Straight talk: Claude is not the best choice for production-grade visual design. For a SaaS product where users are paying real money, use specialized tools for design and use Claude for strategy, copy, and implementation code.

What Claude CAN do well

- ✓ Generate basic SVG logos (geometric, simple)
- ✓ Create design briefs and brand strategy documents
- ✓ Write CSS/HTML code for icons and UI elements
- ✓ Suggest color palettes, typography, and layouts
- ✓ Provide design strategy and brand guidelines

What Claude CANNOT do well

- ✗ Generate raster images (PNG, JPG) at production quality

- ✗ Create photorealistic designs or illustrations
- ✗ Match the polish of Figma, Photoshop, or Illustrator
- ✗ Iterate visually like a human designer
- ✗ Produce complex marketing graphics

> **Bottom Line:** For a production SaaS charging real money, do not use Claude as your primary design tool. Use it for strategy and code; use specialized tools for actual visual design.

2. Recommended Tool Stack

Tier 1: AI-Powered Design Tools

Logo Creation

Tool	Cost	Best For
Looka / Brandmark.io	₹2000-5000 one-time	Professional logo + complete brand kit
Canva Pro	₹4000/year	DIY with templates and brand kit
Fiverr / Upwork	₹3000-15000	Custom unique design (3-7 days)

AI Image Generation

Tool	Cost	Best For
Midjourney	₹800-1700/month	Hero images, concept art, illustrations
DALL-E 3 (ChatGPT Plus)	₹1700/month	Marketing visuals, social media
Leonardo.ai / Bing	Free tier	Budget option with good quality

Favicon & Email Design

Tool	Cost	Purpose
Favicon.io	Free	Generate basic favicons quickly
RealFaviconGenerator	Free	Complete favicon package (all sizes)
Stripo / Beefree	Free tier	Drag-drop responsive email templates

3. Complete Asset List for InterviewEra

1. Primary Logo

- Full logo (text + icon)
- Icon only (favicons, app icons)
- Wordmark only (text)
- Formats: SVG, PNG (transparent), JPG
- Variants: Light bg, Dark bg, Monochrome

2. Favicon Set

- `favicon.ico` (16x16, 32x32, 48x48)
- `apple-touch-icon` (180x180)
- `android-chrome` (192x192, 512x512)
- `safari-pinned-tab.svg`
- `mstile` (150x150 for Windows)
- `manifest.json` for PWA support

3. Social Media Assets

Platform	Profile	Cover/Header
Twitter / X	400x400	1500x500
LinkedIn	400x400	1584x396
Instagram	320x320	—
Facebook	180x180	820x312
YouTube	—	2560x1440

4. OG / Social Sharing Images

- `og-image.png` — 1200x630 (Facebook, LinkedIn)
- `twitter-card.png` — 1200x600
- `whatsapp-preview.png` — 300x200

5. Email Assets

- Email header logo (600x150)
- Email footer with social links
- Signature graphic
- Newsletter template

6. Marketing Materials

- Hero banner variations
- Feature icons (set of 9 for bonus features)
- Testimonial card backgrounds
- Pricing page graphics
- 404 / 500 error page illustrations

7. PWA / Mobile App Icons

- 72x72, 96x96, 128x128, 144x144
- 152x152, 192x192, 384x384, 512x512
- Maskable icons for Android

4. Design Strategy & Brand Personality

Before designing anything, define what your brand stands for. Skip this step and you will redesign everything in 6 months.

Brand Attributes for InterviewEra:

- **Professional** — job interview context demands seriousness
- **Modern** — AI-powered, futuristic feel
- **Trustworthy** — career decisions are high-stakes
- **Empowering** — helping users succeed
- **Tech-forward** — innovative, not generic

Avoid These:

- Childish or playful imagery
- Generic stock photos
- Overused tech clichés (gears, circuit boards, robots)
- Aggressive or intimidating visuals

5. Color Palette & Typography

Recommended Color Palette

Primary Purple	Primary Blue	Accent Cyan
#6366F1	#3B82F6	#06B6D4

Success Green	Warning Orange	Error Red
#10B981	#F59E0B	#EF4444

Dark Background	Dark Card	Text Secondary
#0F172A	#1E293B	#94A3B8

CSS Variables (Copy-Paste Ready)

```
:root {
  /* Primary Brand Colors */
  --primary-purple: #6366F1;      /* Trust, intelligence */
  --primary-blue:   #3B82F6;      /* Professional, stable */
  --accent-cyan:    #06B6D4;      /* Modern, tech */

  /* Glassmorphism Theme */
  --glass-bg:     rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.1);
  --glass-border: rgba(255, 255, 255, 0.2);

  /* Functional Colors */
  --success-green:  #10B981;
  --warning-orange: #F59E0B;
  --error-red:      #EF4444;

  /* Neutrals */
  --dark-bg:        #0F172A;
  --dark-card:      #1E293B;
  --text-primary:   #F8FAFC;
  --text-secondary: #94A3B8;
}
```

Typography Recommendation

```
/* Recommended Font Stack */
--font-heading: 'Inter', 'Plus Jakarta Sans', sans-serif;
--font-body:    'Inter', system-ui, sans-serif;
--font-mono:    'JetBrains Mono', 'Fira Code', monospace;
```

Why these fonts: Free via Google Fonts • Professional appearance • Excellent readability across all screen sizes • Multiple weights available • Optimized for digital screens

6. Logo Design Guidelines

What InterviewEra Logo Should Communicate

Concept Ideas

1. **"Era"** suggests time and progress — use forward-moving elements
2. **"Interview"** suggests conversation — speech bubbles, dialog elements
3. **AI-powered** — subtle tech elements without being cliché
4. **Career growth** — upward trajectory, ascending shapes

Three Design Directions to Explore

A. Modern Wordmark — Custom typography, "IE" monogram, clean bold letters

B. Symbol + Text — Abstract icon (chat bubble + arrow), sound wave, stylized "IE" mark

C. Minimalist Approach — Single letter mark "I" with creative twist, geometric shape with hidden meaning

Critical Design Rules

DO

- ✓ Keep it simple — must work at 16px favicon size
- ✓ Use 1-2 colors maximum
- ✓ Ensure scalability — looks good from 16px to billboards
- ✓ Make it memorable

- ✓ Test on light AND dark backgrounds
- ✓ Verify uniqueness via trademark search

DON'T

- ✗ Use complex gradients in the logo itself
- ✗ Include too much detail
- ✗ Copy competitors (Pramp, Interviewing.io)
- ✗ Use generic stock icons
- ✗ Pick trendy elements that age poorly
- ✗ Use more than 2 fonts

7. Step-by-Step Action Plan

Phase 1: Brand Foundation

Day 1 • 4 hours

Step 1: Define Brand Strategy (1 hour) — Use Claude

Use Claude for:

- Brand positioning statement
- Target audience personas
- Brand values and personality
- Tagline options (5 variants)

Prompt for Claude:
"Create a complete brand strategy for InterviewEra: tagline (5 options), brand voice and tone, target audience profile, unique value proposition, competitor differentiation, and brand personality traits (5 adjectives)."

Step 2: Visual Direction (1 hour)

Tools: **Pinterest, Dribbble, Behance**

- Create a mood board
- Save 20-30 reference designs

- Identify visual patterns you like
- Note colors, typography, and layouts

Step 3: Color & Typography (1 hour)

- Finalize color palette using Coolors.co
- Test color accessibility on WebAIM
- Choose font pairings from Google Fonts
- Create style guide document

Phase 2: Logo Creation

Day 2 • 4-6 hours

Option A: AI Tool Approach (Fastest)

Looka.com workflow:

1. Go to Looka.com, enter "InterviewEra"
2. Select industry: Technology + Education
3. Choose styles: Modern, Minimal, Professional
4. Pick colors: Purple/Blue palette
5. Generate options, refine top 3 choices
6. Purchase brand kit (₹4000-8000)

What you get: Logo in all formats, business cards, social media kit, brand guidelines, email signature, letterhead.

Option B: Hire Designer (Best Quality)

> **Sample Fiverr Brief:**
> "Need modern logo for InterviewEra — AI-powered interview prep SaaS.
> **Style:** Clean, professional, tech-forward
> **Colors:** Purple/Blue palette
> **Deliverables:** Vector files (AI/SVG), PNG transparent, brand guidelines
> **Budget:** ₹5000 • **Timeline:** 5 days • **Revisions:** 3"

Option C: DIY with Canva (Budget)

1. Sign up for Canva Pro (₹500/month, cancel after)
2. Search "SaaS logo templates"

3. Customize with your brand colors
4. Use brand kit feature for consistency
5. Export in all required formats

Phase 3: Favicon & Icons

Day 2 • 1 hour

Workflow with RealFaviconGenerator.net

1. Upload your logo (preferably 512x512 PNG)
2. Configure for each platform (iOS background, Android theme color, Windows tile, Safari pinned tab)
3. Generate package and download zip
4. Add files to `/public/favicon` in Next.js
5. Add HTML code to `<head>`

Output Structure

```
/public
  /favicon
    favicon.ico
    favicon-16x16.png
    favicon-32x32.png
    apple-touch-icon.png
    android-chrome-192x192.png
    android-chrome-512x512.png
    safari-pinned-tab.svg
    mstile-150x150.png
    site.webmanifest
    browserconfig.xml
```

HTML to Add

```
<link rel="apple-touch-icon" sizes="180x180"
      href="/favicon/apple-touch-icon.png">
<link rel="icon" type="image/png" sizes="32x32"
      href="/favicon/favicon-32x32.png">
<link rel="icon" type="image/png" sizes="16x16"
      href="/favicon/favicon-16x16.png">
<link rel="manifest" href="/favicon/site.webmanifest">
<link rel="mask-icon" href="/favicon/safari-pinned-tab.svg"
      color="#6366F1">
<meta name="msapplication-TileColor" content="#6366F1">
<meta name="theme-color" content="#0F172A">
```

Phase 4: Marketing Assets

Day 3 • 4 hours

OG Images (Tool: Canva or Figma)

Create templates for: `og-default.png` (1200x630), `og-blog-template.png`, `og-feature-template.png`. Each should include logo, tagline, visual element, and brand colors.

Social Media Kit (Tool: Canva)

For each platform create: profile pictures (square logo on brand color), cover/header images, post templates (5-10 variations), story templates, and reel/short video covers.

Email Templates (Tool: Stripo.email)

Templates needed:

1. Welcome email (after signup)
2. Verification email
3. Password reset
4. Weekly digest
5. Promotional email
6. Transactional (payment received)
7. Re-engagement (inactive users)
8. Newsletter

Phase 5: Implementation in Next.js

Day 3 • 2 hours

Folder Structure

```
/public
  /favicon         (favicon files)
  /images
    /og            (Open Graph images)
    /logos         (logo variations)
    /illustrations (custom graphics)
  /icons           (UI icons)
```

Update Metadata in app/layout.tsx

```
export const metadata: Metadata = {
  title: 'InterviewEra - AI-Powered Mock Interview Platform',
  description: 'Practice technical interviews with AI feedback.',
  metadataBase: new URL('https://interviewera.com'),
  openGraph: {
    title: 'InterviewEra',
    description: 'AI-powered interview preparation',
    url: 'https://interviewera.com',
    siteName: 'InterviewEra',
    images: [
      {
        url: '/images/og/og-default.png',
        width: 1200,
        height: 630,
      }
    ],
    locale: 'en_IN',
    type: 'website',
  },
  twitter: {
    card: 'summary_large_image',
    title: 'InterviewEra',
    description: 'AI-powered interview preparation',
    images: ['/images/og/twitter-card.png'],
  },
  icons: {
    icon: [
      { url: '/favicon/favicon-32x32.png', sizes: '32x32' },
      { url: '/favicon/favicon-16x16.png', sizes: '16x16' },
    ],
    apple: '/favicon/apple-touch-icon.png',
  },
};
```

8. Budget Breakdown

Minimum Viable — ₹500

- Canva Pro (1 month): ₹500
- Free favicon generator: ₹0
- Free email templates: ₹0
- AI image generation (free tier): ₹0

Recommended — ₹6,300

- Looka brand kit: ₹4,000
- Canva Pro (1 month): ₹500
- Midjourney (1 month): ₹800
- Premium fonts/icons: ₹1,000

Professional — ₹22,000

- Custom logo (Fiverr Pro): ₹8,000
- Brand guidelines document: ₹5,000
- Marketing asset pack: ₹4,000
- Premium illustrations: ₹3,000
- Stock photos subscription: ₹2,000

> **Recommendation for Your Stage:** Go with the **Recommended (₹6,300)** tier. You have ₹1600 revenue and validated demand. Don't overspend on branding before reaching ₹50,000 MRR.

9. Critical Mistakes to Avoid

Don't Do This

- ✗ Use first AI-generated logo without customization
- ✗ Follow trendy 2024-specific designs that'll date quickly
- ✗ Use too many colors (stick to 2-3 max)
- ✗ Make complex logos that fail at 16x16 favicon size

- ✗ Use stock illustrations everywhere — looks unprofessional
- ✗ Have inconsistent assets across platforms
- ✗ Skip mobile preview testing
- ✗ Forget dark mode testing
- ✗ Skip trademark search before finalizing
- ✗ Export low-resolution files (always export 2x for retina)

Do This Instead

- ✓ Start with strategy — define brand before designing
- ✓ Test at all sizes from 16px to 1920px
- ✓ Get feedback from 5+ people before finalizing
- ✓ Create a written style guide
- ✓ Version control all asset versions
- ✓ Plan for scaling and future needs
- ✓ Optimize file sizes (TinyPNG, SVGOMG)
- ✓ Test on different devices and platforms
- ✓ Verify accessibility (color contrast, readability)
- ✓ Backup everything to cloud storage

10. Claude's Role in This Process

Use Claude For

- ✓ Brand strategy and positioning
- ✓ Tagline and copywriting generation
- ✓ Email content writing
- ✓ Marketing copy
- ✓ SEO descriptions and meta tags
- ✓ Social media captions
- ✓ Brand guidelines documentation
- ✓ Color palette suggestions
- ✓ Implementing assets in code (Next.js)
- ✓ HTML/CSS for email templates

Don't Use Claude For

- ✗ Generating final logo designs
- ✗ Creating illustrations
- ✗ Photo editing
- ✗ Complex graphics or marketing visuals
- ✗ Print materials
- ✗ Photography direction

11. Action Items & Final Reality Check

Next 2 Hours

- ✓ Create Pinterest mood board for InterviewEra
- ✓ Decide on color palette using Coolors.co
- ✓ Choose 2 fonts from Google Fonts
- ✓ Sign up for Looka or Brandmark
- ✓ Generate 5 logo concepts

Tomorrow

- ✓ Finalize logo (with feedback from 3 people)
- ✓ Generate complete favicon set
- ✓ Implement in Next.js code
- ✓ Create OG images
- ✓ Test on production deployment

This Week

- ✓ Complete social media kit
- ✓ Design email templates
- ✓ Update all marketing materials
- ✓ Document brand guidelines
- ✓ Launch with new branding

Final Reality Check

Your priorities right now (in order):

1. **CRITICAL:** Fix XSS vulnerability
2. **CRITICAL:** Migrate to interviewera.com domain
3. **HIGH:** Implement payment system
4. **HIGH:** Get to 100 users
5. **MEDIUM:** Perfect branding (you are here)

Branding matters, but not as much as security and product. Spend 2-3 days max on this. Don't fall into the perfectionism trap. You can always rebrand later when you have ₹50,000 MRR and need to look more premium.

Quick and good > slow and perfect.

Ship it. Iterate. Improve.